

**diplomacy** CIA PAPERS

# HOW CHINA DUPED NEHU

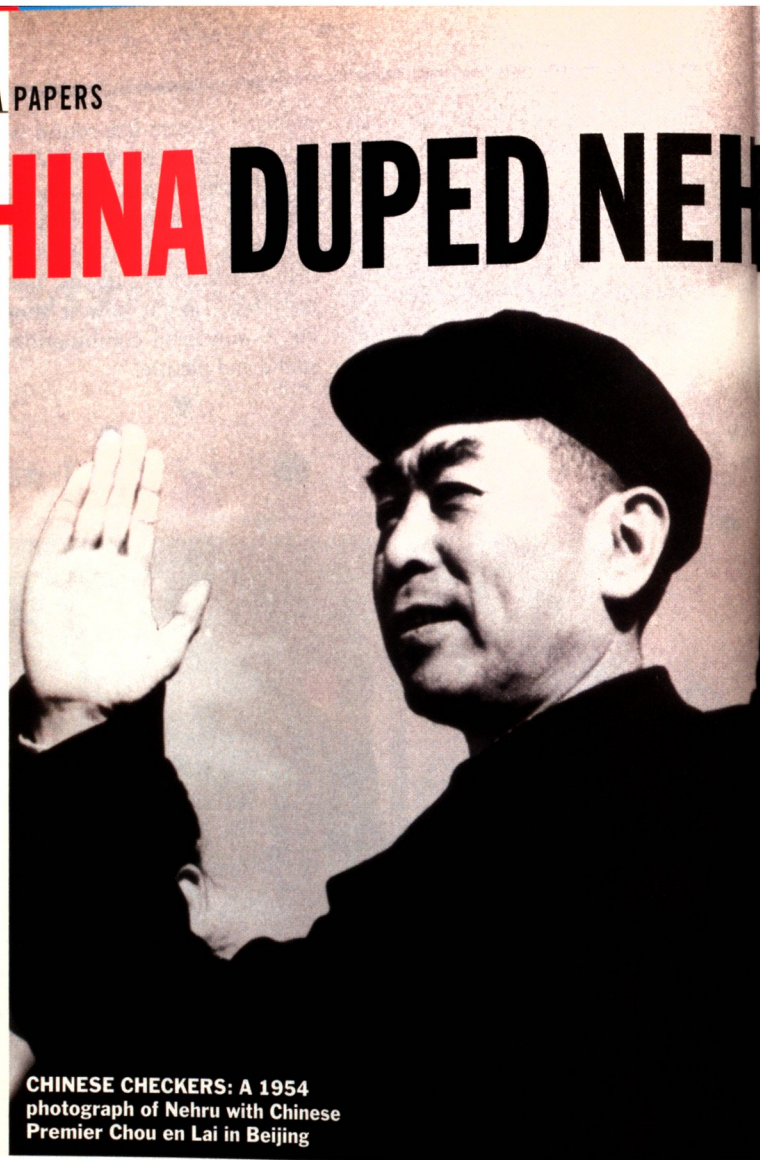
**Recently declassified CIA documents present an account of China's gameplan of intrigue and deception that led to the 1962 Sino-India war**

■ By Saurabh Shukla

**T**he *Art of War* was written by the Chinese strategist Sun Tzu in 500 B.C., and is still considered a gospel for war and strategic thinking in organisations around the globe, and if the recently declassified CIA documents are to be believed, the Chinese mastered it perfectly in the run up to the 1962 Sino-India war. The war remains one of the most humiliating defeats for India that affected the Indian morale and damaged India's efforts to present itself as an emerging power. It also pointed to the lapses on the part of the Indian political and military leadership that led to the war.

Delhi has maintained silence and has not reacted and the Chinese have trashed the analysis, but the CIA papers present an American insight into the difficult relationship between the two neighbours India and China. Written soon after the 1962 crisis by a senior analyst, the report uses both documents and discussions in the public domain as well as private assessments to arrive at its conclusions. Its overall thrust, which is not inimical to India's analysis of the debacle, is an exposition of how Chinese Premier Chou en Lai tried to deceive the Indian Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru, through a strategy of persuasion and coercion.

The question though remains as to



**CHINESE CHECKERS:** A 1954 photograph of Nehru with Chinese Premier Chou en Lai in Beijing

why China, despite Nehru's *Hindi-Chini bhai bhai* monologues, betrayed India, and went to war with it in 1962? According to the CIA analysis it seems that China considered India to be a long term threat and the Chinese leadership wanted to deliver a major blow to India's political and military leadership, and demonstrate its big power status. The paper quotes the Chinese

President Liao Shao Chi in his discussions with the Swedish ambassador in 1963 as saying: "The attack had taught India a lesson and that for future Nehru and the Indians must be taught that they can not change the border status quo by force." Liao earlier told a Colombo conference that "China was a great power and had to punish India once...China really can't accept India's

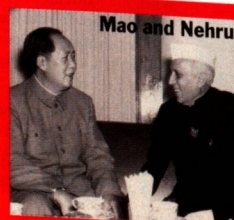


**1949:** India recognises the People's Republic of China.

**1950:** India opposes UN resolutions branding China as an aggressor in the Korean war.

**1954:** China and India sign Panchsheel treaty.

**1955:** India objects to the inclusion of a portion of northern frontier on the official map of China.



**1956:** Chou en Lai visits India for the second time. The border question is formally raised.

**1958:** India objects to inclusion of parts of Assam and NEFA as part of Chinese territories in its maps.